

Chapter 36 - Taking Initiative

Yan Lin had gotten off work on time today for once. She had been taking most of her meals at the hotel where she was staying recently. Now that she had relaxed, Feng Yue's figure once again occupied her mind.

If they hadn't divorced and were still like before, the place she should be returning to now would be their shared home. And at home, what would greet her would be warm yellow lights and hot food on the table, and most importantly, the person waiting for her at home.

Yan Lin leaned back in her chair, her neatly combed long hair hanging messily over her shoulders, with a few strands falling across her forehead. She closed her eyes and sighed heavily.

Before long, Mo Yixu pushed the door open: "President Yan, today's work has been completed. Should I call the driver for you?"

Yan Lin didn't speak, just closed her eyes thinking about something. Mo Yixu didn't rush her, just waited quietly.

After a while, Yan Lin opened her eyes and sat up, casually tidying her disheveled hair: "Come with me to Green Hill for dinner."

After speaking, she stood up and walked out. Halfway there, she remembered something and asked: "You don't have plans today, do you?"

Mo Yixu nodded: "No, I don't. I'll accompany you."

"Mm."

Green Hill was a French restaurant located on the rooftop of Hengyang Building. To dine there, you needed to make reservations a week in advance, but for Yan Lin this wasn't necessary—she had a private room permanently reserved at this restaurant.

Yan Lin had quite liked the almond lamb leg and onion soup made by this restaurant's chef in the past, but because French meals always took a long time, Feng Yue didn't like coming here.

However, since Yan Lin enjoyed these two dishes, Feng Yue had studied how to make them at home.

Compared to the restaurant chef's skills, Yan Lin was naturally more accustomed to Feng Yue's cooking, so the two rarely went to this restaurant for meals afterward.

Perhaps because she had gotten off work relatively early today, Yan Lin found herself missing Feng Yue terribly when she had free time, and naturally also missed these two dishes that Feng Yue had made for her.

But she and Feng Yue could now almost be called strangers, so Yan Lin could only settle for second best and come to this restaurant again.

Since no reservation was needed, Yan Lin was immediately escorted to the private room upon arriving at the restaurant.

This wasn't Mo Yixu's first time accompanying Yan Lin for a meal, but it was his first time sitting face-to-face with Yan Lin alone for dinner.

Mo Yixu was actually quite curious about Yan Lin. In business, Yan Lin was naturally decisive and authoritative without question. But after leaving the company, Mo Yixu felt he couldn't understand this woman.

In private, Yan Lin didn't like to talk and showed no emotions, like a machine that had been working for a long time and lost its vitality after being powered down.

But this was only Yan Lin's state when she was alone in private. When she was with Miss Feng, her emotions rarely showed either, but she would devote part of her attention to the other person.

Mo Yixu had initially found their interaction very strange, and looking at it now, it indeed was.

No one could tolerate Yan Lin's private state, and in the end, even Miss Feng had divorced her.

The two sat in the private room without talking, each doing their own things. Mo Yixu looked at his phone browsing gossip, while Yan Lin also looked at her phone, but was reading some foreign news.

The two had a peaceful meal together. Yan Lin got to eat those two long-missed dishes as she had wished, but her taste buds sent a strong protest.

This wasn't the taste she was used to.

Yan Lin found the food tasteless, while Mo Yixu ate quite happily.

When the two finished their meal and were preparing to leave, Yan Lin caught sight of Feng Yue sitting not far away.

She had originally planned to just quietly watch her for a while, but her peripheral vision caught a familiar figure walking toward Feng Yue.

The person was unsteady on her feet, her right foot seeming to have some problem. Yan Lin looked at the champagne glass in her hand that was obviously fuller than usual, and had a bad feeling.

Yan Lin quickened her pace to follow, and as she expected, Wang Huili nearly spilled wine all over Feng Yue.

Seeing the pure white blouse gradually revealing the skin underneath after being soaked with alcohol, Yan Lin decisively removed her own coat and draped it over Feng Yue.

When she saw Wang Huili acting against Feng Yue, her heart felt like it was instantly set on fire.

When she heard the other person making excuses to brush things off, the anger in her heart intensified. She had never been someone good at enduring, especially when Wang Huili was targeting Feng Yue.

She retaliated in kind by pouring half a glass of champagne on the other person. Seeing Wang Huili's face contort, she finally felt a bit better.

Yan Lin thought she could use this opportunity to have a good conversation with Feng Yue, but obviously she was overthinking it.

She had underestimated Feng Yue's annoyance with her.

Yan Lin watched Feng Yue and Wen Zhen leave together, feeling somewhat lost.

What exactly should she do?

Yan Lin sat there quietly, one hand moving slightly to rest on the back of the chair where Feng Yue had once sat.

Pitifully and sadly attempting to retain Feng Yue's scent in this way.

The restaurant staff stood not far away, wanting to come forward and ask if Yan Lin needed help, but Mo Yixu stopped them.

He thought their President Yan probably wanted to be alone for a while.

Yan Lin turned her head and looked through the floor-to-ceiling glass beside her at the endless stream of vehicles below and this city of myriad lights.

Yan Lin wanted a home, wanted a home with Feng Yue, wanted her home to also be one of those myriad lights.

What she wanted, she should fight for herself. Avoiding Feng Yue didn't mean she herself should stay in place without taking a single step forward.

Otherwise, sooner or later, Feng Yue would be taken away by someone else.

That Wen Zhen was her biggest rival.

"Assistant Mo." Yan Lin called.

Mo Yixu stepped forward: "President Yan."

"Songhe Bay, Building 7, 13th floor. Try contacting this property owner and ask if they're willing to sell. Price is not an issue. If that doesn't work, see if you can ask other floor owners."

Mo Yixu blinked, understanding something, then nodded slightly in agreement.

If he remembered correctly, Miss Feng currently lived in Songhe Bay, specifically on the 14th floor of Building 7.

Their President Yan's intentions were crystal clear.

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The area where Feng Yue's clothes had been soaked with alcohol was right in the middle of her chest. After leaving the restaurant, she and Wen Zhen went straight to the shopping mall downstairs.

After casually picking out an outfit at a clothing store, Feng Yue went into the fitting room.

After changing clothes, she finally breathed a sigh of relief and leaned against the fitting room wall.

The small space with only Feng Yue inside undoubtedly gave her an infinite sense of security. The noisy outside world was shut out by the fitting room door, and now in this small space, she was alone.

Feng Yue wasn't someone without a temper. When Wang Huili "accidentally" splashed wine all over her, her first reaction was confusion, followed by anger.

She believed she had no conflicts with Wang Huili whatsoever. Even in her previous life when she had encountered her being quite intimate with Yan Lin at the entrance of Yan Corporation, she hadn't done anything to her.

There had been no grudges even in her previous life, let alone this life.

She felt this was completely an unprovoked disaster.

However, Yan Lin's actions were too quick. Before she could properly confront Wang Huili, Yan Lin had swiftly avenged her.

Feng Yue admitted that she felt pleased seeing Wang Huili soaked just like herself, but after coming to her senses, she didn't feel as satisfied.

If she had been the one to splash wine all over Wang Huili, she would have been happier.

But speaking of which, Beijing really was small. She had previously encountered Yan Lin and Fu Sixue at Wen Zhen's shop, and this time she encountered Yan Lin and Wang Huili here.

Feng Yue stood in the fitting room thinking about various things, and before long, Wen Zhen came to knock on the door.

"A Yue, are you okay? Do the clothes not fit?"

Hearing Wen Zhen's voice, Feng Yue finally collected her thoughts: "No, no, I've changed. I'm coming out now."

Feng Yue came out of the fitting room holding her dirty clothes, handed them to the sales associate to wrap up, then tidied her hem and went to look in the mirror.

The outfit she was wearing had been chosen by Wen Zhen—a cream-colored long dress with silk printed patterns, black trim at the neckline and cuffs, and two heart-shaped buttons arranged vertically on the chest as decoration.

Overall, it matched Feng Yue's style very well.

Wen Zhen stood behind Feng Yue, looking at her through the mirror, appearing quite satisfied: "It seems my eye isn't bad—I picked out a dress that suits you perfectly at first glance."

Feng Yue looked at herself in the mirror and nodded with satisfaction, showing her approval: "Sister Wen Zhen has very good taste."

"Want to browse other things? Or should we go home now?" Wen Zhen stepped forward two steps and asked.

She was afraid that what had just happened had ruined Feng Yue's mood. Although she didn't really want to end this alone time with Feng Yue like this, she still made this suggestion.

Sure enough, Feng Yue pondered for a moment, then pressed her lips together: "Let's go home. It's getting late, and don't you have to go to the shop tomorrow, Sister Wen Zhen?"

Wen Zhen nodded. She did indeed have to go to the shop tomorrow, but that was in the afternoon. However, she didn't expose Feng Yue's excuse, just led her to the checkout counter, then handed her card to the cashier before Feng Yue could.

"Sister Wen Zhen, I'll pay for it myself. You don't need to." Feng Yue reached out to stop her, then took out her card from her bag.

Wen Zhen pressed down her arm and turned to say gently: "Today was supposed to be a celebration, but we ended up having a little accident. Consider this dress my apology gift to you." She placed her card in front of the cashier.

"How can you be blamed for this! And having dinner with me was already a celebration." Feng Yue furrowed her brows. "Besides, you've already given me so many gifts."

"Do you remember when I left during dinner? I had originally borrowed the restaurant's kitchen to prepare a little gift for you, but now I can't give it to you, so let this dress be a substitute."

Feng Yue looked at Wen Zhen's serious and earnest gaze focused on her, and the words of refusal just wouldn't come out.

Wen Zhen had clearly prepared another gift for her, but because of Wang Huili's appearance, all of it had come to nothing.

Although it wasn't Feng Yue's fault, she still felt it was because of her that Wen Zhen's efforts had been wasted.

Seeing that Feng Yue was no longer insisting, Wen Zhen successfully swiped her card, then took Feng Yue's bag of dirty clothes and left the clothing store.

Feng Yue felt somewhat sorry for Wen Zhen, so after getting back in the car, she said apologetically: "Sister Wen Zhen, I'm sorry about today. And your preparations were ruined too."

Wen Zhen looked at her drooping head, which reminded her very much of the gentle-natured rabbit at home, and couldn't help but reach out to ruffle her hair.

Wen Zhen laughed softly: "This can't be blamed on you, you don't need to feel guilty. And whether it's the dress or what I prepared in the kitchen, they were all meant for you. As long as you don't feel disappointed, then I don't feel it's a pity either."

"Besides, it's not like we can never go out to eat again, right? This time was just to celebrate your ten thousand followers. As long as you're willing, we can celebrate twenty thousand, thirty thousand, even a hundred thousand or a million together."

"So don't feel sorry. I was very happy to have dinner with you, and I was also very happy preparing gifts for you."

"As for the result, let's wait for next time."